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H. Farley
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SFE 104/1

6 August 1945

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STATE-WAR-NAVY COORDINATING SUBCOMMITTEE FOR THE F/R EAST

POLITICO-MILITARY PROBLEMS OF THE FAR EAST: NATIONAL COMPOSITION OF FORCES TO OCCUPY FORMOSA (INCLUDING THE PESCADORES) IN THE POST-DEFEAT PERIOD: RELATIONS OF THE MILITARY GOVERNMENT OF FORMOSA WITH CHINA AND THE CHINESE

References: a. SWNCC 16/2
b. SWNCC 53
c. SWNCC 68
d. SFE 104

Note by the Secretary

1. At their 31st meeting on 4 August 1945, the Subcommittee recommitted SFE 104 to the Working Group for reconsideration in the light of SWNCC 87/2 and of General Roberts' memorandum of 3 August 1945.

2. General Roberts' memorandum is reproduced at the enclosure, but without the quotations from SWNCC 87/2 as referred to in paragraph 1.a.

HUGH D. FARLEY
Lieut. USNR
Secretary

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ENCLOSURE

STATE-WAR-NAVY COORDIN'TING COMMITTEE
SUBCOMMITTEE FOR THE FAR EAST
Munitions Building
Washington, D. C.

3 August 1945

Memorandum for Mr. H. M. Benninghoff:
Captain Lorenzo Sabin:

Subject: SFE 104 - National Composition of Forces to Occupy Formosa

1. As written this paper is not acceptable to me, for the following reasons:

a. Paragraph 7 reads: "The United States should occupy and establish military government in Formosa unless circumstances make it possible for China to undertake this responsibility." In my opinion, which is based on known War Department policy and also on the policy as expressed in SWNCC 87/2 (paragraph 5 of the Discussion and paragraph 12d of the Conclusion, attached for your convenience), the statement should be revised to read, "China should occupy and establish the military government of Formosa unless circumstances make it impossible for her to undertake this responsibility." I can see no good reason why the U.S. should set up, at considerable cost, the military government for a territory which is to become Chinese. It is implicit in the paper that there is no confidence in the "ability of the Chinese to exercise such responsibilities." (paragraph 10, page 2). What this boils down to, is that the Chinese probably will not govern Formosa as efficiently as we would, nor in the same way. If followed to the logical conclusion, this attitude would have us in Formosa for the next 4000-odd years - which is manifest absurdity.

b. If it becomes necessary for us to assault Formosa in order to reduce it, then there is no question but that we should establish the initial military government. In such case, our forces would simply spearhead Chinese assault and presumably would be withdrawn at a very early stage. At the time of the withdrawal military government should be turned over to the Chinese.

c. If, however, it is a matter of merely accepting the surrender of the Japanese on Formosa then the occupying forces should be Chinese, even though the United States would have to provide certain shipping and troops to run the port facilities. I can see no necessity whatever for the United States to assume the burden of an interim government between the time the Japanese flag is hauled down and the Chinese flag hoisted.

2. I recommend that the paper be recommitted by informal agreement of the SFE members and that the Working Party produce a paper in line with the provisions of 87/2 and of the foregoing discussion. Will you please inform the Secretary, Lt. Farley, of your concurrence or informally give him your comments.

Enclosure

F.N. ROBERTS
Brig. Gen., USA
Army Member

cc: Lt. Col. Fahey
cc: Lt. Farley